PLUR.			
Nom. Acc.	**cyningas**	**englas**	**heofenas**
Gen.	**cyninga**	**engla**	**heofena**
Dat.	**cyningum**	**englum**	**heofenum**

The vowel in the medial syllable generally disappeared in the inflected forms of dissyllabic words when tne first syllable was long and the second short. It also generally disappeared when the first syllable was short and the second syllable ended in vocalic **l, m, n** in West Germanic (§ **219**). On the retention or the loss of the medial vowel in the inflected forms of dissyllabic words, see § **221**.

§ **339**. Like **cyning** are declined **æcer,** *field*; **cocer,** *quiver*; **hærfest,** *autumn*; **hengest,** *horse*. **brīdels,** *bridle*; **fǣtels,** *vessel, tub*; for other examples of nouns ending in **-els**, see § **598**. **æþeling,** *prince*; **cnæpling,** *youth*; **gædeling,** *companion*; **lȳtling,** *child*; for other examples of nouns ending in **-ling**, see § **607**.

§ **340**. Like **engel** are declined **ǣled,** *fire*; **angel,** *fish-hook*; **āþum,** *son-in-law*; **bealdor,** *prince*; **bīetel,** *mallet*; **blōstm,** *blossom*; **bolster** (also neut.), *bolster*; **bōsm,** *bosom*; **brēmel,** *bramble*; **dēofol,** *devil*; **dryhten,** *lord*; **ealdor,** *prince*; **finger,** *finger*; **hleahtor,** *laughter*; **māþum,** *treasure*; **morgen,** *morning*; **ōfer,** *shore*; **þȳmel,** *thimble, thumbstall*; **wæstm,** *growth*.

botm, *bottom*; **ellen** (also neut.), *zeal, courage, strength*; **fæþm,** *embrace*; **fugol,** *bird, fowl*; **hæg(e)l, hagol,** *hail*; **ofen,** *oven*; **nægl,** *nail*; **reg(e)n,** *rain*; **þeg(e)n,** *thane*.

But nouns like **bulluc,** *bullock*; **cassuc,** *sedge*; **langoþ,** *longing* (for other examples of nouns ending in **-oþ, -aþ**, see § **595**); **mattuc,** *mattock*; **pearroc,** *park*, generally retain the medial vowel.

§ **341**. Like **heofon** are declined **bydel,** *beadle*; **cradol,** *cradle*; **daroþ,** *dart, spear*; **eodor,** *enclosure*; **eofor,** *boar*; **hafoc, heafoc,** *hawk*; **hamor,** *hammer*; **heorot,** *stag, hart*;

metod, *Creator*; **rodor**, *sky*; **sadol**, *saddle*; **stapol**, *pillar*; **þunor**, *thunder*. On the variation of the vowel in the medial syllable, see § **222**.

§ **342.** *Neuter.*

SING.			
Nom. Acc.	**word**, *word*	**hof**, *dwelling*	**fæt**, *vessel*
Gen.	**wordes**	**hofes**	**fætes**
Dat.	**worde**	**hofe**	**fæte**
PLUR.			
Nom. Acc.	**word**	**hofu**	**fatu**
Gen.	**worda**	**hofa**	**fata**
Dat.	**wordum**	**hofum**	**fatum**

The neuter **a**-stems had the same endings as the masculine except in the nom. and acc. plural. The prim. Germanic ending of the nom. acc. plural was **-ō** which became **-u** and then regularly disappeared after long stem-syllables (§ **215**). In late OE. the long stems often had **-u** in the plural after the analogy of the short stems.

§ **343.** Like **word** are declined a large number of monosyllables with long stem, as **ār**, *brass*; **bǣl**, *funeral pile*; **bān**, *bone*; **bearn**, *child*; **bēor**, *beer*; **blōd**, *blood*; **bold**, *dwelling*; **bord**, *board*; **brēost**, *breast*; **corn**, *corn*; **dēor**, *wild animal*; **dūst**, *dust*; **fām**, *foam*; **fearn**, *fern*; **feax**, *hair*; **fleax**, *flax*; **folc**, *folk*; **gēar**, *year*; **gearn**, *yarn*; **gield**, *payment*; **gold**, *gold*; **hord** (also masc.), *treasure, hoard*; **horn**, *horn*; **hors**, *horse*; **hrēod**, *reed*; **hrīs**, *twig*; **hūs**, *house*; **īs**, *ice*; **lām**, *clay*; **land**, *land*; **lēaf**, *leaf*; **lēan**, *reward*; **lēoþ**, *song, poem*; **līc**, *body*; **līn**, *flax, linen*; **mān**, *crime*; **mōd**, *mind, courage*; **morþ**, *murder*; **nēat**, *ox*; **nest**, *nest*; **nīþ**, *enmity*; **sār**, *pain*; **scēap**, *sheep*; **seax**, *knife*; **sweord**, *sword*; **tōl**, *tool*; **þing**, *thing*;

weorc, *work*; **weorþ**, *worth, price*; **wīf**, *woman*. And similarly words with a prefix, as **behāt**, *promise*; **gebeorc**, *barking*. See § **259** on nouns whose stems ended in double consonants: **fell**, *skin*; **full**, *cup*; **toll**, *tax, toll*.

§ **344**. Like **hof** are declined **broc**, *affliction*; **broþ**, *broth*; **ceaf**, *chaff*; **col**, *coal*; **dor**, *door*; **geoc**, *yoke*; **god**, *god* (*heathen*); **hol**, *hole*; **loc**, *lock*; **lot**, *deceit*; **sol**, *mud*; **spor**, *track*. And similarly words with a prefix, as **bebod**, **gebod**, *command*. **geat** (§ **72**), *gate*, pl. **gatu** beside **geatu** with **ea** from the singular.

Nouns which have **e**, **i** in the stem originally had **u**-, **o**/**a**-umlaut in the plural, as **gebeodu**, *prayers*, gen. **gebeoda**, dat. **gebeodum**; and similarly **geset**, *seat, dwelling*; **gesprec**, *speaking*, see § **48**. **cliofu**, *cliffs*, gen. **cliofa**, dat. **cliofum**; and similarly **brim**, *sea*; **hlid**, *lid*; **lim**, *limb*; **scip**, *ship*; **twig**, *twig*; **geflit**, *strife*; **gewrit**, *writing, letter*. **friþ** (OHG. **fridu**), *peace*, and **liþ** (Goth. **liþus**), *limb*, were originally masc. **u**-stems. See §§ **101–2**.

§ **345**. Like **fæt** are declined **bæc**, *back*; **bæþ**, *bath*; **blæc**, *ink*; **blæd**, *leaf*; **bræs**, *brass*; **cræt**, *cart*; **dæl**, *dale*; **fæc**, *period of time, space*; **fær**, *journey*; **fnæd**, **fnæs**, *fringe*; **gærs** from older ***græs**, *grass*; **glæs**, *glass*; **græf**, *grave, cave*; **hæf**, *sea*; **sæp**, *sap*; **scræf**, *cave*; **swæþ**, *track*; **træf**, *tent*; **þæc**, *thatch, roof*; **wæd**, *water, sea*; **wæl**, *slaughter*. See §§ **54**, **57**.

§ **346**. **flāh**, *fraud*, gen. **flās**, dat. **flā**; **þēoh**, *thigh*, gen. **þēos**, dat. **þēo**, pl. **þēo**, gen. **þēo**, dat. **þēom**; **pleoh**, *danger*, gen. **plēos**, dat. **plēo**, pl. **plēo**; **holh**, *hollow, hole*, gen. **hōles**, dat. **hōle**, pl. **holh**, see § **149**. **feoh**, *cattle*, originally belonged to the **u**-declension (§ **399**).

§ **347**. Sing.

Nom. Acc.	**tungol**, *star*	**wæter**, *water*	**hēafod**, *head*
Gen.	**tungles**	**wæteres**	**hēafdes**
Dat.	**tungle**	**wætere**	**hēafde**

PLUR.			
Nom. Acc.	**tungol**	**wæter**	**hēafodu**
Gen.	**tungla**	**wætera**	**hēafda**
Dat.	**tunglum**	**wæterum**	**hēafdum**

Dissyllabic words which in West Germanic ended in vocalic **l, n, r** (§ **219**) syncopated the medial vowel in the gen. and dat. sing. and plural and lost the final **-u** in the nom. and acc. plural when the stem-syllable was long. So that the nom. acc. sing. and plural became alike just as in the monosyllabic long stems. Original trisyllabic words (§ **223**), and also dissyllabic words which in West Germanic ended in vocalic **n, r,** retained the medial vowel in the gen. and dat. sing. and plural, but lost the final **-u** in the nom. and acc. plural when the stem-syllable was short. Original trisyllabic words syncopated the medial vowel in the gen. and dat. sing. and plural, but retained the medial vowel and the final **-u** in the nom. and acc. plural when the stem-syllable was long. See §§ **216, 223.**

NOTE.—In the later period of the language there was great fluctuation in the formation of the plural and in the loss or retention of the medial vowel, as nom. acc. plural **tunglu, wæt(e)ru, hēafdu** beside older **tungol, wæter, hēafodu**; gen. sing. **wætres** beside older **wæteres.**

§ **348.** Like **tungol** are declined **ātor,** *poison*; **bēacen,** *beacon*; **cnōsl,** *race, progeny*; **fācen,** *deceit*; **fōdor,** *fodder*; **spātl,** *saliva*; **tācen,** *token*; **wǣpen,** *weapon*; **wolcen,** *cloud*; **wuldor,** *glory*; **wundor,** *wonder.*

§ **349.** Like **wæter** are declined **brægen,** *brain*; **gamen,** *game, sport*; **leger,** *couch*; **mægen,** *strength*; **ofet,** *fruit*; **reced,** *house, hall*; **weder,** *weather*; **weorod, werod,** *troop,* pl. **weredu** (§ **222**) beside **werod. setl,** *seat,* pl. **setlu** beside **setl.**

§ **350.** Like **hēafod** are declined **clīewen, clīwen,** *ball of thread, clew*; **mǣden, mægden,** *maiden*; **nīeten,** *animal.*

b. **ja**-STEMS.

§ **351.** *Masculine.*

SING.			
Nom.	Acc.	**secg**, *man*	**ende**, *end*
	Gen.	**secges**	**endes**
	Dat.	**secge**	**ende**
PLUR.			
Nom.	Acc.	**secg(e)as**	**endas**
	Gen.	**secg(e)a**	**enda**
	Dat.	**secg(i)um**	**endum**

It is necessary to distinguish between those stems which were originally long and those which became long by the West Germanic doubling of consonants (§ **254**). The **j** caused umlaut of the stem-vowel and then disappeared in the inflected forms except after **r** (§§ **271–2**). When the **j** came to stand finally after the loss of prim. Germanic **-az**, **-an** it became vocalized to **i** which remained in the oldest period of the language, and then later became **e** (§§ **215**, Note, **274**), cp. **here**, *army*, **ende**, *end*, beside Goth. acc. **hari, andi.** The OE. forms with double consonants in the nom. and accusative singular are all new formations from the inflected forms. The regular forms would be ***sege**, *man*; ***dyne**, *noise* = Goth. acc. ***sagi**, ***duni.**

§ **352.** Like **secg** are declined **bridd**, *young bird*; **cnyll**, *knell*; **dyn(n)**, *noise*; **hlyn(n)**, *loud sound*; **hrycg**, *back, ridge*; **hyll**, *hill*; **mæcg** (§ **55**, Note 3), *man*; **mycg**, *midge*; **wecg**, *wedge.* See § **259.**

§ **353.** The **j** (written **i**, **g**, **ig**; also **ige** before a guttural vowel, § **268**) remained medially after **r** preceded by a short vowel, as nom. acc. **here**, *army*; gen. **heries, herges, heriges**; dat. **herie, herge, herige**; pl. nom. acc. **herias, hergas, herigas, herigeas**; gen. **heria, heriga, herigea**; dat. **herium, herigum.** Forms without **j** also occur occasionally, as gen. **heres**, dat. **here**, pl. **heras.**